

Hyderabadi Chicken Dum Biryani (2 kg Chicken, 8–10 People)

Ingredients

Chicken Marinade

- Chicken (bone-in) – **2 kg**
- Thick curd – **400 g**
- Ginger-garlic paste – **4 tbsp (60 g)**
- Red chilli powder – **3 tbsp**
- Coriander powder – **2 tbsp**
- Turmeric powder – **1 tsp**
- Garam masala – **2 tsp**
- Salt – **4 tsp**
- Lemon juice – **2 lemons**
- Mint leaves – **1 cup**
- Coriander leaves – **1 cup**

Marinate for **at least 2 hours** (overnight is best).

Rice

- Aged basmati rice – **1.5 kg**
 - Recommended: India Gate Classic or Daawat Biryani Basmati

Wash Rice

Wash 4–5 times until water becomes almost clear.

Soak Rice

Soak for **30 minutes only**.

Fried Onions (Birista)

- Onions – **1 kg (8 large onions)**

Slice thinly and fry until golden brown.

Divide into:

- **500 g fried onions** for chicken layer
 - **500 g fried onions** for rice layer
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Mint & Coriander

- Mint leaves – **1 cup total**
 - ½ cup for chicken layer
 - ½ cup for rice layer
 - Coriander leaves – **1 cup total**
 - ½ cup for chicken layer
 - ½ cup for rice layer
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Whole Spices for Rice Water

- Bay leaves – **4**
 - Green cardamom – **8**
 - Cloves – **8**
 - Cinnamon – **2 sticks (2-inch each)**
 - Star anise – **2**
 - Shah jeera – **2 tsp**
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For Saffron Milk (Optional)

- Warm milk – **4 tbsp**
 - Saffron – **10–15 strands**
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Ghee

- Ghee – **4 tbsp** (optional but recommended)
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STEP 1 – Marinate Chicken

In a very large bowl add:

- 2 kg chicken
- 400 g curd
- 4 tbsp ginger-garlic paste
- 3 tbsp red chilli powder
- 2 tbsp coriander powder
- 1 tsp turmeric
- 2 tsp garam masala
- 4 tsp salt
- Juice of 2 lemons
- 1 cup mint leaves
- 1 cup coriander leaves

Mix thoroughly with your hands.

Cover and marinate for **2–12 hours**.

STEP 2 – Make Fried Onions

Slice 1 kg onions very thin.

Heat oil.

Fry onions in batches.

When they become golden brown, remove immediately.

They will darken further as they cool.

Keep aside.

STEP 3 – Prepare Rice Water

Take a large vessel.

Add:

- 5 litres water
- 4 bay leaves
- 8 cardamoms
- 8 cloves
- 2 cinnamon sticks
- 2 star anise

- 2 tsp shah jeera
- 5 tbsp salt

Bring to a rolling boil.

STEP 4 – Cook Rice to 70%

Drain soaked rice.

Add rice to boiling water.

Cook for approximately **6–8 minutes**.

Check frequently.

Test Grain

Take one grain and press it.

It should:

- Be soft outside
- Have a slight hard core inside

This means it's 70% cooked.

Immediately drain all water.

Do not cook completely.

STEP 5 – Layer Chicken

Take a thick-bottom handi or large vessel.

Spread all the marinated chicken evenly on the bottom.

Add First Layer

- 500 g fried onions
- ½ cup mint leaves
- ½ cup coriander leaves

Spread evenly.

STEP 6 – Layer Rice

Spread all the drained rice over the chicken.

Add Second Layer

- Remaining 500 g fried onions
- Remaining ½ cup mint leaves
- Remaining ½ cup coriander leaves

Spread evenly.

STEP 7 – Add Final Toppings

Pour evenly:

Saffron Milk

- 4 tbsp warm milk mixed with saffron

Ghee

- 4 tbsp ghee

Sprinkle across the rice.

STEP 8 – Dum Cooking

Close the lid tightly.

You can seal with dough if available.

High Flame

Cook for **10 minutes**.

Low Flame

Cook for **35–40 minutes**.

Total dum time:
45–50 minutes

STEP 9 – Rest

Turn off the flame.

Do not open the lid.

Rest for **15 minutes**.

STEP 10 – Serve

Open carefully.

Using a large spoon, lift rice from the bottom and side.

Do not mix aggressively.

Serve with:

- Raita
 - Mirchi Ka Salan
 - Boiled egg (optional)
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Most Important Tips

- ✓ Use aged basmati rice.
- ✓ Soak only 30 minutes.
- ✓ Cook rice only to 70%.
- ✓ Use thick curd.
- ✓ Marinate at least 2 hours.
- ✓ Rest 15 minutes after dum.
- ✓ Don't overmix while serving.

These steps will give you fluffy, non-sticky, restaurant-style Hyderabad Chicken Dum Biryani with 2 kg chicken. 🍗🍚🔥

